

Budget-Constrained Evaluation of Open-Weight LLM Agents: Success–Budget Curves, Price Reversal, and Thinking-Budget Saturation

Weiming Shen

Independent Researcher, Suqian, Jiangsu, China

Email: 19708110566@139.com

ORCID: 0009-0006-8222-1668

Corresponding author: Weiming Shen

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Data availability. All code, evaluation trajectories, and per-token cost records are publicly archived on Zenodo (DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.21215799) and on GitHub (<https://github.com/shenzxc/budget-constrained-agent-eval>), released under MIT (code) and CC BY 4.0 (data).

Generative AI use. AI-based coding and language tools assisted implementation and manuscript preparation; all design, analysis, and claims are the author’s own and were verified against the released data.